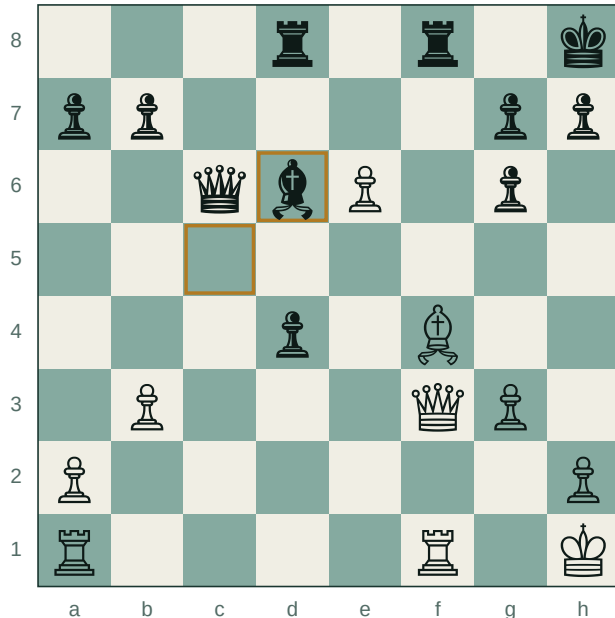


Intermediate moves: White, move 27

Intermediate moves

White to move



Previous move: 26...Bxd6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27. Qxc6 bxc6 28. Bxd6

27.Qxc6 The queen captures the queen on c6. Recorded reply: **27...bxc6**.

28.Bxd6 The bishop captures the bishop on d6. The changed line means the rook on f1 attacks the rook on f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 18 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The postponed recapture may disappear. The intermediate move must win enough or preserve the right to recover material.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An intermediate move interrupts an expected sequence with a stronger immediate threat. Instead of recapturing automatically, use a check or another forcing move to change the result.

HOW TO LOOK

Before every routine recapture, scan checks, queen attacks, and mating threats. Return to the original capture only if it still helps.

The defending king is on h8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.